

Hiring Partner Project

Your Guide to Standing Out

Overview

Hiring partner projects are one of the most important opportunities in your cohort experience. They are your chance to demonstrate real-world skills, show your professionalism, and make a lasting impression on a potential employer. This isn't just a coding exercise — it's a window into who you are as a developer and a collaborator.

This Is a Collaborative Effort

This project is a learning experience, and the cohort is your greatest resource. Talk with your cohort about your approach. Review each other's work. Give honest, specific feedback. Discuss what makes a project feel polished and professional. Don't wait until you're done to share — share early and often.

Also reach out to Derek and Jon — they've seen many projects and have real insight into what hiring partners respond to. Ask them what they've seen work, what's fallen flat, and what questions to be ready for.

And take advantage of mock interviews. Practice presenting your project with Jon, Derek, or another instructor before the real thing. The first time you walk through your project out loud should not be in front of a hiring partner.

What Makes a Great Hiring Partner Project

1. Completes the Ask

First and foremost: do what was asked. Read the project requirements carefully and fulfill every part of them. Incomplete submissions signal poor attention to detail and a lack of follow-through — two things no employer wants to see.

- Read the requirements more than once before you start building
- Check off every deliverable before submitting
- When in doubt, ask a clarifying question early — not at the deadline

2. Usable & Deployed

A project that only runs on your machine isn't done. Your submission should be live and accessible — something the hiring partner can click on right now.

- Deploy to a platform like Vercel, Netlify, Railway, or similar
- Test it in a browser you didn't develop in — things break in unexpected places
- Include a clean README with setup instructions if a local run is also required

3. Adds Value

The best projects don't just check boxes — they solve a real problem or improve something meaningful for the business. Ask yourself: does this actually help someone?

- Think about the end user's experience, not just the technical implementation
- Look for small extras that make a big difference — loading states, error handling, accessibility

- If you have time, add one thoughtful feature that wasn't asked for — and explain why you added it

4. Shows You Know Their Business

This is where most candidates fall short — and where you can stand out immediately. Hiring partners notice when a candidate takes the time to actually understand their brand and business.

- Use their color scheme — pull their hex codes from their website or brand guidelines
- Match their font styles — check Google Fonts or their CSS for what they use
- Reference their actual products, services, or language in your project where appropriate
- Spend 30 minutes on their website, LinkedIn, and any press they've gotten before you write a single line of code

5. Come Prepared with Talking Points

Building the project is half the work. Being able to confidently present and defend it is the other half. Know your project inside and out.

- Explain how it works — be ready to walk through your architecture, tech choices, and data flow
- Explain how it fits their business — frame your project in terms of the value it delivers to them specifically
- Prepare for the "why did you build it this way?" question for every major decision
- Practice your presentation out loud — once to yourself, once with a peer

6. Put Your Style Into It

You are not just submitting code — you are submitting yourself. Hiring partners want to see who you are as a developer. Let your personality, creativity, and point of view come through.

- Don't just copy a tutorial structure — make intentional design decisions and own them
- Think about what makes your solution uniquely yours
- Write code you're proud to show — clean, readable, and intentional

Your 2-Day Roadmap

Day 1 — Research, Plan, Build

1. Read the project brief twice. Highlight all deliverables.
2. Research the hiring partner — website, LinkedIn, product, brand.
3. Note their colors, fonts, and any industry-specific language.
4. Wireframe or outline your approach before building.
5. Build the core functionality. Get it working first.

Day 2 — Polish, Deploy, Present

6. Refine UI to match the hiring partner's brand.
7. Add your personal touches — the extras that show you care.
8. Deploy and test on a live URL.
9. Write your README and prepare your talking points.
10. Practice your presentation at least twice out loud.

